Clear Sample Data Guide

Remove the sample portfolio, keep every formula, and start fresh safely. Read this BEFORE entering your own RESP transactions.

THE GOLDEN RULE

NEVER delete rows from the RESP Portfolio, the RESP Tracker, the Main Dashboard, the Dividend Tracker or Analysis & Reco. The only tab you clear is the Transaction Log.

ALWAYS press the Delete key on the selected cells. It clears the values and keeps every formula intact; every other tab resets to $0.00 on its own.

Why first? If you add your real contributions and grants on top of the 8 sample rows, your totals, CESG per child and $50,000 limit check will all be wrong.

8 STEPS TO CLEAR THE SAMPLE DATA

1. **Make your copy first**
   Click your template link, click “Make a copy,” and rename it. Always work from YOUR copy in Google Drive.

2. **Open the Transaction Log**
   Click the Transaction Log tab at the bottom of the screen. It holds the 8 sample transactions.

3. **Find row 4**
   Row 1 is the title and row 3 holds the column headers. Row 4 is the first sample transaction (2026-01-15).

4. **Select all sample rows**
   Click cell A4, then press Ctrl+Shift+End (Windows) or Cmd+Shift+End (Mac). This selects rows 4 to 11.

5. **Press the Delete key only**
   Press Delete. Not Backspace, and not right-click → Delete rows. The values clear and every formula stays in place.

6. **Check the reset**
   The Main Dashboard should show $0.00, the RESP Portfolio should be empty, and the RESP Tracker should show $0 CESG for every child.

7. **Update Settings & Goals**
   Fill in the amber cells: your name, the Active Year, each child’s name and date of birth, and your goals.

8 **Enter your first transaction**
Go back to the Transaction Log and start at row 4. Every tab updates instantly.

THE 8 SAMPLE ROWS YOU'RE CLEARING

Row	Date	Type	Ticker	Description	Amount
4	2026-01-15	Contribution		RESP Contribution — Child 1	$2,500
5	2026-01-20	Buy	TSE:XBAL	iShares Core Balanced ETF	50 × $28.40
6	2026-02-15	Buy	TSE:VGRO	Vanguard Growth ETF	40 × $40.60
7	2026-03-01	CESG		CESG Grant — Child 1	$500
8	2026-03-15	Contribution		RESP Contribution — Child 2	$2,500
9	2026-03-20	Buy	TSE:XEQT	iShares Core Equity ETF	30 × $36.80
10	2026-06-01	CESG		CESG Grant — Child 2	$500
11	2026-09-15	Dividend	TSE:XBAL	Quarterly distribution	$42.30

TAB-BY-TAB REFERENCE

Tab	Has sample data?	What to do
Transaction Log	YES: rows 4 to 11	Press Delete on rows 4+ only. Never delete the rows themselves.
Main Dashboard	No, formulas only	Do nothing. It resets when the Transaction Log is cleared.
RESP Portfolio	No, formulas only	Do nothing. It fills in from the Transaction Log.
RESP Tracker	No, formulas only	Do nothing. CESG per child calculates on its own.
Dividend Tracker	No, formulas only	Do nothing. It calculates on its own.
Analysis & Reco	No, formulas only	Do nothing. It calculates on its own.
Settings & Goals	YES: sample values	Replace the amber cells with your own name, children and goals.
Start Here	No, instructions	Read once. No changes needed.
ChartData	No, formulas only	Never touch. Hidden helper for the charts.

VERSION HISTORY: YOUR SAFETY NET

Google Sheets saves every change. If something goes wrong: File → Version history → See version history. Find the version from just before the mistake and click "Restore this version."

> Pro tip: before clearing, name the current version. File → Version history → Name current version → "Before clearing sample data."